

8 Time

Speaking 1: time

- A** Talk with a partner. Look at the people in the two pictures. How do they see time differently?



Vocabulary 1: time or no time

- A** Check the highlighted words and phrases in these questions about the two pictures. Then answer them with a partner.

1. Who has **plenty of time**?
2. Who is **short of time**?
3. Who is always **in a hurry**?
4. Who likes to **take time** to do things?
5. Who doesn't want to **waste time**?



Vocabulary 2: time expressions

- A** Complete the sentences with the correct form of the verbs below.

spend pass save have waste take

1. Sorry, I don't _____ time to help you now. I'll try to do it later.
2. If you _____ your time to do it, you'll do a much better job.
3. At the weekend, I like to _____ time with my family.
4. I think every minute is important. I don't like to _____ time.
5. When I'm on the train, I often play computer games on my laptop to _____ the time.
6. Booking flight tickets online instead of going to a travel agent really _____ time.

- B** Match the words and phrases 1–5 with the words and phrases a–e that have the same meaning.

- | | |
|--------------------|------------------|
| 1. in the future | a. for ages |
| 2. for a long time | b. straightaway |
| 3. immediately | c. ages ago |
| 4. a long time ago | d. from now on |
| 5. at first | e. to begin with |

- C** Use the pairs of phrases in Exercise B to complete these sentences.

1. James is my oldest friend. I met him _____ / _____.
2. I've known Peter _____ / _____. We went to the same university.
3. I didn't really like Lucy _____ / _____, but now she's a good friend.
4. I want you to deal with the problem _____ / _____. Not tomorrow or next week.
5. You were lucky there wasn't an accident. You must be more careful _____ / _____.

Grammar check

Time can be uncountable.

I don't have time.

Or it can be countable and mean the same as *occasion*.

I remember the time I lost my passport. / How many times have you been there?

When we ask questions with *how long*, we don't need to use *time*.

How long did you spend in Europe? ✓

NOT *How long time did you spend in Europe?* ✗

Watch out!**typical errors**

How much time have you met him? ✗

How long time have you been here? ✗

Pronunciation check

When one word ends in a sound that is similar to the sound at the beginning of the following word, the two sounds merge together.

 Listen to these examples from the unit.

1. waste time 2. spend time

 Now listen to these new examples.

1. take care 2. big gun 3. time machine

Practise saying all the phrases.

Speaking 2: questions and answers

A Talk with a partner. Answer these questions.

1. How long have you known your best friend?
2. How long does it take to get from your hometown to the capital of your country?
3. How long does it take you to get ready in the morning?
4. How long did you spend at college or university?

B Ask and answer these questions with the same partner.

1. Do you have much free time? How do you like to spend it?
2. Are you usually in a hurry or do you like to take your time?
3. How do you pass the time during a long flight or train journey?
4. Do you ever feel that you are wasting time?

Speaking 3: answering the question

A Look at these questions from the third part of the Speaking Module. Think about how you would answer them.

1. Does modern technology really save us time, or is it just one more thing to worry about? _____
2. Does modern technology mean that some people have *too much* free time? _____
3. Do people spend too long thinking about the future instead of enjoying now? _____
4. What is more important – time or money? _____



Exam tip: You must answer the questions that the examiner asks. You can't just say something that you have practised. If you don't understand the question, ask the examiner to repeat it or explain what he or she means.

B  Listen to some students answering the questions in Exercise A. Mark each sentence (Y) if the student answers the question and (N) if the student doesn't.

C  Listen again as you read the tapescript. Notice that answers do not have to be grammatically perfect to be good answers.

D Walk around the class. Ask and answer the questions in Exercise A with different classmates.

Listening

8

Listening 1: completing a table

A You will hear a talk to a class of students. Look at the pictures. What do you think the topic of the talk will be?



Question-type tip: In both the Listening and Reading Modules of the exam, you will sometimes need to complete information in a table.

B Look at the table below. Answer these questions with a partner.

1. How does a table help you predict what you will listen to?
2. How does the table help you know what you need to listen for?
3. Match parts of the table to the pictures in Exercise A.



Exam tip: A table helps you because you can predict how a talk will be organized and divided into parts. You know when the speaker is going to go from one topic to another because you can follow the squares on the table.

C Listen to the first part of the talk and complete the table. Write no more than two words or a number for each answer.

Date	Method of recording history	Notes
150,000 – 200,000 years ago	Storytelling	Not reliable – (1) _____ forgotten and elements added.
32,000 years ago	Cave (2) _____	Images of large (3) _____ so perhaps to bring luck when hunting.
(4) _____ BC	Egyptian hieroglyphics	Beliefs and events recorded on walls (5) _____ and on monuments.
(6) _____ BC	Written word	Ancient Greeks recorded events for (7) _____ generations. First (8) _____ lived in Greece.

D Compare answers with a partner. Did the table format make the task easier?

Listening 2: practise completing a table

A  Listen to the second part of the talk and answer the questions.

For questions 1–12, complete the table. Write no more than two words or a number for each answer.

Date	Method of recording history	Notes
8 th century AD	Paper and woodblock (1) _____	More books – so more people learnt (2) _____.
(3) _____ century AD	Printing press	(4) _____ produced more quickly.
1605	First (5) _____	People knew about events more quickly.
Mid-19 th century	(6) _____	People saw reality of war. People wanted to know the (7) _____.
End of nineteenth century	Motion picture camera	First (8) _____ images.
1930s	Television	History brought into people's (9) _____.
Today	(10) _____ TV / Internet Video camera / mobile phone	Every (11) _____ is recorded. People watch as it happens. People can record (12) _____ history.

B Check the key on page 269. How many questions did you answer correctly?

C Tick the sentences about the listening task that are true for you and think about how you can answer more questions correctly next time.

- I looked at the table carefully before I listened.
- The table helped me predict the type of word or phrase that I needed for most spaces.
- I understood the speaker and knew which words to write in the spaces.
- I spelt most of my answers correctly and used capital letters when necessary.
- I am pleased with how many questions I answered correctly.

Key vocabulary in context

Circle the correct option in these sentences.

- A **century** is a *hundred* / a *thousand* years.
- A **generation** of people is a group of people who live *in the same place* / *at the same time*.
- A **tradition** is something that people have *done for a long time* / *just started doing*.
- Historians** are people who *study the past* / *can look into the future*.

Pronunciation check

Century is pronounced /'sentʃəri/.

 Listen to these phrases and then practise saying them.

- eighteenth century
- nineteenth century
- twentieth century

Reading

8

Reading 1: understanding the general idea

A Talk in small groups. Look at the picture and answer the questions.

1. Do you know the movie?
2. Who are the two characters in the picture?
3. What are they trying to do?
4. What happens in the rest of the movie?
5. Do you believe that time travel is possible?



B Read the text and put these key words into the correct space.

physics stories moments scientists

Time Travel – Fantasy or Reality?

Time travel is the idea of moving between different (1) _____ in time in the same way that it is now possible to move between different points in space. Time travel would involve sending objects backwards in time to a moment before the present, or forwards from the present to the future, without the need to experience the period in between.

Based on theories of time dilation, gravity and relativity, one-way time travel into the future might be possible, but it seems that the laws of (2) _____ would not allow time travel backwards into the past. People argue that if you travelled back in time, you could change events.

Changing events would probably lead to a chain of other events that would mean that you would not be born and so would not exist.

Some (3) _____, however, believe that travelling back in time might take the traveller to a parallel universe. This means that the moment the traveller arrived in the past, his history would begin to change from the history he has already experienced.

Many books and films have told (4) _____ of time travel, but the well-known scientist, Stephen Hawking, suggests that time travel is not possible because nobody from the future has visited Earth. He believes that if generations from the future could travel in time, they would be visiting us.

Reading 2: completing a summary

A Complete this summary of the first two paragraphs of the text using words from the box. You do not need to use all the words.

moments time past people points
existence history objects possibility space

Time travel would mean moving between points in time in the same way that we now move between points in (1) _____. That means travelling backwards into the (2) _____ or forwards into the future without living through the (3) _____ in between. It seems that forward travel is a (4) _____ but that travelling back in time is probably not. If a person could travel back in time, they might change something in a way that would threaten their (5) _____. Stories about time travel are very popular, but if time travel is possible, why are (6) _____ from the future not visiting us?

B Compare your answers with a partner. Why do some words not fit in some spaces?



Question-type tip: Sometimes when you complete a summary, you will choose words from the text. Sometimes you will choose words from a box.

C Talk with a partner. Mark these statements about the task you have just done (T) true or (F) false.

1. The words in the box will always be words from the text. _____
2. Choosing words from a box is easier than choosing words from the text. _____
3. It is clear which words in the box I should use and which I should not. _____
4. When I use a word, I should cross it out so that I don't use it again. _____



Exam tip: Choosing words from the box is not easier than choosing words from the text. The words in the box are not always the same as the words in the text. The words in the box that you don't need are usually similar in meaning to the words that you need. Once you have used a word from the box, cross it out.

D Complete the summary below with words from this box.

different	living	future	believe	visiting	unlikely
coming back	future	change	popular	similar	history

Time travel would mean travelling between points in time in a way that is (1) _____ to how we now move between points in space. That means travelling backwards into the past or forwards into the (2) _____ without (3) _____ through the time in between. It seems that forward travel is a possibility, but that being able to travel back in time is (4) _____. If a person could travel back in time, they might (5) _____ something in a way that would threaten their existence. Books and movies tell stories of time travel, but if time travel is possible, why are people from the future not (6) _____ to visit us?

E Check your answers and then answer these questions with a partner.

1. How is the second summary task different from the first?
2. How do the two task types test different aspects of your English?



Exam tip: Sometimes the words in the box are all the same part of speech (usually nouns) and the task checks overall comprehension. Sometimes the words in the box are different parts of speech and the task tests your grammar, too. Always read the summary carefully and look at what comes before and after a space so you know what part of speech to use.

The summary will not always be a summary of the whole text. Often it will summarize part of the text and you will need to first identify which part.

Reading 3: practising completing a summary

A Do you remember the highlighted words in these questions? Check and answer the questions with a partner.

1. At what age do people **retire** in your country?
2. How do most people spend their **retirement**?

B Read the web page, which gives advice about different ways of spending retirement.

For questions 1–4, match the headings a–e with the sections. Write the letters in the spaces. There is one heading that you do not need to use.

- | | | |
|-------------------------|----------------------|---------------------|
| a. Carry on working | b. Go back to school | c. Travel the world |
| d. Give somebody a hand | e. Get out more | |





Retirement Opportunities

Retiring might mean having more time to do the things you have always wanted to. Or it might mean looking for new ideas to do things you never thought you would enjoy. Either way, there is a whole range of opportunities that you can enjoy in retirement.

- 1
Learning can be fun and a great way to relax and meet people. It doesn't need to be formal study, and you don't need to study for a qualification. It's easy to find free courses and, if you're learning for fun, you can choose anything you find interesting – whether it's something new or a subject you already know about. Look at our education and learning section for more advice and links to local colleges.
- 2
When you retire, you'll probably have more time to enjoy your favourite leisure activities, and you will probably be keen to take up a new interest or activity to fill your spare time. Our sports, leisure and tourism section has information about what you can do in and around the local area.
- 3
Doing voluntary work allows you to work in a way that suits your timetable. It's a very good way to put into use your skills and experience to help others, and at the same time learn something new. There are all sorts of organizations that need volunteers. Think about what you can offer and what you want to get from it.
- 4
Reaching the age that you are entitled to a pension doesn't mean that you have to stop working. You can either continue to work and claim your pension entitlement, or delay your claim and get paid more later.

Related Information: [Further and Higher Education](#) [Over 60s](#) [Reduced costs of travel](#)

For questions 5–12, complete the summary below with words from the box. You do not need to use all the words.

voluntary work	fun	retirement	study	different	wait
work	stop	leisure	first time	hobby	experience

When you retire, you will have time and there are many (5) _____ ways to enjoy it. You can do what you have always wanted to do or try new things for the (6) _____. A lot of people go back to college and learn something. They have (7) _____ and meet people. Other people want to enjoy their favourite leisure activities, and many begin a new (8) _____. Helping others by doing (9) _____ is a popular way of using skills and experience. You should remember, though, that being of (10) _____ age doesn't mean that you can't (11) _____. Many retired people claim a pension and have a job, or (12) _____ until later to start claiming.

C Check the key on page 269. How many questions did you answer correctly?

D Tick the sentences about the reading task that are true for you and think about how you can answer more questions correctly next time.

1. I read the summary and looked at the words in the box carefully before I started the second task.
2. I found it challenging to read the text and the summary at the same time.
3. I thought about both the meaning of words and if they fitted grammatically into the summary.
4. I was happy with how quickly I answered the questions and the number I answered correctly.

WB For focus on reading skills, go to Workbook page 23.

Writing: making a request**A** Answer these questions with a partner.

1. Do you have enough time to do everything you need to do?
2. Do you ever feel that you have too much to do in too little time?
3. Do you sometimes need to delay things you have to do because you don't have time?

MONDAY

9.00 AM	study
10.00 AM	
11.00 AM	meeting supervisor
12.00 AM	
13.00 AM	LUNCH
14.00 AM	write report
15.00 AM	history class
16.00 AM	review for test
17.00 AM	
18.00 AM	

B Look at the instructions for a writing task below. Highlight the key words and check that you understand what you have to do.

You chose to study four subjects at college, but you also need to do a part-time job to support yourself. You are finding it impossible to do everything properly.

Write a letter to your college explaining why you need to give up one of your courses. Ask if it is possible to have a refund.

Write at least 150 words. You should spend about 20 minutes on this task.

C Answer these questions with a partner.

1. Is it an easy or difficult letter to write?
2. Do you know what to say?
3. Should the letter be formal or informal?
4. Write the opening line, stating why you are writing.

D The letter should be formal. Tick the option in each pair below that is right for the letter.

1. A I'm writing because I can't do one of my courses anymore.
B I am writing to ask if it is possible for me to give up one of the courses I am studying.
2. A Now I do four subjects and I've got a part-time job.
B I am currently studying four subjects and doing a part-time job.
3. A There's too much work and it's all too much for me.
B I am finding it impossible to cope with so much work.
4. A When the academic year began, I was confident that I had the time.
B At the start, I thought I could do everything.
5. A I now realize that that is not possible.
B I was wrong!
6. A I do not want to give up History of Art, but I am afraid I have no other option.
B I don't want to give up History of Art but I have to.
7. A I want my money back.
B I would like to know if it is possible to claim a refund.

8. A I apologize for any inconvenience that I will cause.
B Sorry if I've made some problems for you.
9. A Thanks for everything.
B Thank you for your kind consideration.

E Read the model letter and check your answers in Exercise C.

Dear Professor Cameron,

I am writing to ask if it is possible for me to give up one of the courses I am studying. The course I want to give up is History of Art, which is on Tuesday and Thursday mornings. I am currently studying four subjects and doing a part-time job. I am finding it impossible to cope with so much work.

When the academic year began, I was confident that I had the time to study four subjects and continue to work. I now realize that that is not possible. I enjoy History of Art and I do not want to give it up, but I am afraid I have no other option. I must continue working while I study in order to support myself.

I would like to know if it is possible to claim a refund for the History of Art course as I have only been to two of the lessons. I apologize for any inconvenience that I will cause. I am sure that with the extra time I have, I can focus better on my studies. Thank you for your kind consideration.

Yours sincerely,

Brian Howard



Exam tip: Try to learn some typical fixed expressions for each type of letter. Even if your vocabulary is limited and you make grammatical mistakes, you will gain marks if you use the right expressions in the right place.

F Highlight expressions that you want to remember and use when you write a request letter.

G Cover the letter. Seven words are spelt incorrectly in these typical expressions. Correct them.

1. I am writing to ask if it is posible for me to ...
2. I am curantly studying ...
3. I am finding it inpossible to cope with ...
4. I do not want to ... but I am afraid I have no other opson.
5. I apologize for any inconviniance ...
6. Thank you for your kind considarasion.

H Look at the exam practice section on page 108 for the writing task.

Speaking

A Complete these sentences so that they are true for you.

1. I like to **take my time** when I _____.
2. I'm often **in a hurry** when I _____.
3. If _____, I think it's best to _____ straightaway / immediately.
4. I would like to **have more time** to _____.
5. I **spend too much of my time** _____.

Grammar check

If the phrase **spend time** is followed by a verb, the verb is in the *-ing* form.
I spend a lot of my time travelling to meetings.

B Look again at the questions from the third part of the Speaking Module on page 99.

C  Listen to some students answering the questions. How do they give themselves time to think?

D  Listen again and fill the gaps below.

1. Mm, that's _____ question.
2. _____?
3. Mm, I haven't really _____ before.
4. I don't know if _____ that in only a minute. It's _____ question.



Exam tip: If the examiner asks you a difficult question and you need time to think, there are several expressions you can use before you give an answer.

E Work with a partner. Ask difficult questions and practise giving yourself time to think.

Vocabulary

A Fill the gaps in these sentences with key words from the unit. Some letters are given to help you.

1. People don't want more lies. They want the t _ _ _ h.
2. I apologize if my decision has caused any inc _ _ v _ _ _ _ _ _ _.
3. Do you believe that life ex _ _ _ _ on other planets?
4. America was discovered in the fifteenth c _ _ _ _ _.
5. I'm finding it difficult to c _ _ _ with so much work and so little time.
6. It is very unl _ _ _ _ y that people will be able to travel in time soon.
7. I hope the next gen _ _ _ _ _ will look after the planet better than we do.
8. Do you know where the tr _ _ _ _ _ n of shaking hands started?

Errors

A There are errors in all of these sentences. Correct them.

1. How much time have you been to Europe?
2. How long time will you stay in Paris?
3. How long do you know your best friend?
4. It's not good to waste the time.
5. In future I hope to study in the USA.
6. First I didn't like Tony, but now I think he's really nice.
7. I spend a lot of my free time to play golf.
8. I passed two weeks in Greece last year.

Exam Practice

8

Writing

- A** Look carefully at the instructions for this writing task. Highlight the key words and make sure you understand what you have to do.

You are currently studying on a full-time course at a university. Something has happened and you need to take two weeks off.

Write a letter to the principal of the university requesting the time off and explaining why you need it.

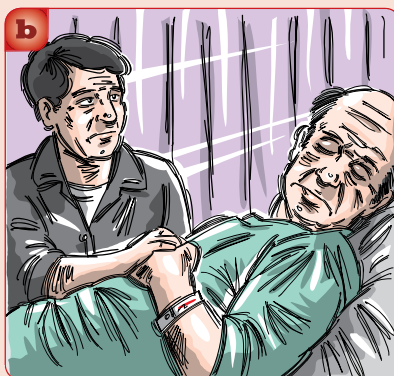
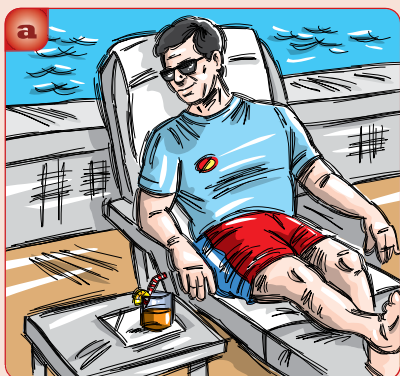
Write at least 150 words.



Exam tip: Sometimes you will need to invent some of the information that you write in your letter – what course you are studying, when you need to take time off and why you need to take time off, for example.

- B** Look at these pictures and answer the questions with a partner.

1. Why does the student want to take time off from his studies in each case?
2. Do you think they are all good reasons for taking time off from a course you are studying?



- C** Answer these questions with a partner. You will need to invent answers.

1. What course are you studying?
2. When do you need the time off?
3. What has happened? Why do you need the time off?
4. Are you going to apologize?
5. Are you going to request that your lecturers tell you in advance what they will do in the lectures that you miss?
6. Are you going to request that your lecturers give copies of any materials to one of your classmates?
7. How are you going to close your letter?

This image shows a full page of white paper with horizontal blue or grey ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page, typical of notebook paper. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the page.